



PHOTO BY RACHIT GOSWAMI



NISABA GODREJ

46, Executive Chairperson, Godrej Consumer Products Ltd

Growing Under Pressure

Nisaba Godrej has ensured that GCPL's growth stays on track even during tough times

BY ARNAB DUTTA

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NISABA GODREJ, THE

Executive Chairperson of Godrej Consumer Products Ltd (GCPL), has sustained the company's business amid faltering volume offtake in the country's vast FMCG market. While urban consumption trends in the mass market segments followed the path of distressful rural market sales, Godrej's leadership skills ensured that GCPL continues to grow. In FY24, its sales grew 5.8% year-on-year to surpass ₹14,000 crore. Its bottom

WHY SHE MATTERS

Amid a challenging business environment, she not only grew GCPL's sales but also ventured into new categories through a successful ₹2,825-crore acquisition of Raymond's Park Avenue and Kamasutra brands

line, however, suffered due to higher finance costs and the implications of a major acquisition.

The ₹2,825-crore acquisition of Raymond's Park Avenue and Kamasutra brands may have dented GCPL's profitability in FY24 (it posted a net loss of ₹560 crore), but it is a major step forward under her leadership. The deal has expanded GCPL's total addressable market as it ventures into new categories like deodorants, premium men's personal care products and sexual wellness, which have high growth potential. Investors have rewarded the stock, with GCPL's market capitalisation surging more than 32% to more than ₹1,30,428 crore on the BSE by October-end. **BT**

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MAKING A BOLD BET

Schauna Chauhan is making a big bet on dairy, a difficult space in India, while also diversifying Parle's portfolio

BY ARNAB DUTTA

FOR MOST PEOPLE, a period of disruption is the time to focus on survival. But for Schauna Chauhan of Parle Agro, the period of disruption is the time for innovation and doubling down on the growth agenda. That is the reason why, when after the pandemic newer challenges emerged in the form of supply chain disruptions and steep inflation due to geopolitical crises, Chauhan decided to go all out in search of new sets of rules to stay ahead of the curve. It was one thing to enter the dairy category at the peak of the pandemic, for instance. But it is another thing that despite challenges on multiple fronts, Chauhan is now doubling down on her bet—this despite a murky track record of corporate biggies in the country's dairy space. That is when her experience comes in handy.

The CEO of Parle Agro—makers of popular packaged beverages such as Frooti and Appy Fizz—remains as confident about success in the dairy space as she was when the company invested heavily to enter the business in mid-2021, a time marked by the deadliest Covid-19 wave. Dairy is a category where multiple attempts by corporate giants like Coca-Cola or Nestlé have reaped limited success